



“ WE CANNOT
WALK ALONE...
WE CANNOT TURN
BACK... I HAVE A
DREAM TODAY! ”

Martin Luther King Jr.
speaking at a rally in 1963

SECOND WAVE OF FEMINISM

The “first wave” of feminism addressed legal obstacles, such as votes for women, while the second focused on sexuality and family. Simone de Beauvoir’s *Le Deuxième Sexe* defined the woman’s movement and exploded the myth that women were second class citizens.



front of the Rathaus Schöneberg (City Hall) to hear him speak. In a strongly defiant message to the Soviets, Kennedy described West Berlin as a symbol of freedom.

His speech dashed any hopes held by Moscow that the allies would abandon West Berlin.

Relations between East and West were still strained following the **Cuban Missile Crisis** (see 1962). The incident had raised worldwide concerns about nuclear contamination, which led to talks about a treaty to ban **nuclear testing** in the atmosphere, space, and under water. The **Test Ban Treaty** was signed in Moscow by the foreign ministers of the Soviet Union, the US, and Britain on August 5. It was ratified by the US Senate on September 24 and came into force on October 11.

Meanwhile, the **campaign for racial equality** in the US moved a step closer to victory on August 28. A crowd of over 250,000 civil rights protestors gathered at the Lincoln Memorial for a mass “**March on Washington**” for jobs and freedom. Many leading figures spoke, including **Martin Luther King Jr** who famously stated “**I have a dream**,” while predicting a day when the promise of freedom and equality for all would become a reality in the US.

Another historical day for the US was November 22, when president John F. **Kennedy was assassinated** as he traveled

through Dealey Plaza, Dallas, in an open-top car. Texas governor John Connally was also injured. Both of their wives, who were with them, were unharmed. Secret Service agents immediately stormed the School Book Depository building, where shots had been heard, and found a rifle with a telescopic lens. Just under an hour later, a policeman approached **Lee Harvey Oswald** and was shot dead. Oswald was arrested and charged with the murder of the policeman and Kennedy’s assassination.

Traveling back to Washington, DC on board the presidential

plane, *Air Force I*, Vice President **Lyndon B. Johnson** was sworn in as the 36th US president. Kennedy’s **funeral** took place on November 25. The world’s reaction to the news was one of overwhelming shock.

Two days after Kennedy’s assassination, Lee Harvey Oswald, the man charged with the murder, was shot and killed. Oswald, a former marine, was being transferred from police headquarters to jail. He was surrounded by police and journalists. In the melee, **Jack Ruby**, a Dallas nightclub owner, stepped forward and shot

Oswald. He later stated that he had done it “for Jackie Kennedy.” The murder was filmed and seen live on televisions across the US. Oswald had denied he was responsible for Kennedy’s death, which fueled conspiracy theories. In an attempt to investigate the truth, the **Warren Commission** was set up on November 29 to examine the facts.

Kennedy funeral

Over one million people lined the route of Kennedy’s funeral procession, which ended at Arlington National Cemetery. Millions more watched it on TV.



“ ALL FREE MEN... ARE
CITIZENS OF BERLIN. ”

John Fitzgerald Kennedy, June 26, 1963

